

Spanish A1 — Week 4 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 4

Theme: -er and -ir Verbs, Reflexive Verbs, and Daily Routine

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 4 completes the regular verb picture in Spanish and introduces reflexive verbs for daily routine.

In Week 3, you learned -ar verbs. This week you add the other two families: -er and -ir. Once you know all three, you can conjugate the majority of Spanish verbs. The new endings are small adjustments, not a whole new system.

You will also learn reflexive verbs — the verbs Spanish uses for actions you do to or for yourself: getting up, showering, getting dressed, going to bed. You already know one reflexive verb: *me llamo*. It has been there since Session 1.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 4

By the end of Session 8, you should be able to say a complete daily routine:

Me despierto a las seis y media. Me levanto a las siete. Me ducho rápido y me preparo en veinte minutos. Luego como algo y bebo un café. Trabajo de nueve a seis. Por la noche, leo un poco o veo una serie. Me acuesto hacia las once.

And describe someone else's routine:

Mi compañera se llama Ana. Se levanta muy temprano — a las seis. Come en la oficina. Vive cerca del trabajo. Se acuesta tarde porque lee mucho por las noches.

The Three Verb Families Side by Side

Subject	-ar (hablar)	-er (comer)	-ir (vivir)
yo	hablo	como	vivo
tú	hablas	comes	vives
él/ella	habla	come	vive
nosotros	hablamos	comemos	vivimos
vosotros	habláis	coméis	vivís
ellos	hablan	comen	viven

The pattern to notice: The *yo* form always ends in -o. The *tú* form always ends in -s. The *ellos* form always ends in -n. What changes is the vowel in between — -a for -ar verbs, -e for -er and -ir verbs.

How Reflexive Verbs Work

A reflexive verb has a small pronoun before it that says the action comes back to the subject:

Subject	Pronoun	Example
yo	me	me levanto
tú	te	te levantas
él / ella	se	se levanta
nosotros	nos	nos levantamos
vosotros	os	os levantáis
ellos	se	se levantan

The verb itself conjugates like any regular verb. The pronoun is the only new part.

A Note on Two Tricky Verbs

Despertarse (to wake up) and *acostarse* (to go to bed) change their vowel in most forms:

- *despertarse*: e → ie: *me despierto, te despiertas, se despierta*
- *acostarse*: o → ue: *me acuesto, te acuestas, se acuesta*

For now, just use *me despierto* and *me acuesto* as phrases. You will learn the full stem-change system in Week 6. The *nosotros* form is regular: *nos despertamos, nos acostamos*.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 7 — before Session 8:

1. **Say -er and -ir verb endings from memory.** -o, -es, -e, -emos, -éis, -en and -o, -es, -e, -imos, -ís, -en. Say them with *comer* and *vivir*.
2. **Write 3 sentences about yourself** — one -ar, one -er, one -ir verb.
3. **Say them out loud.** Third try without notes.

After Session 8 — before Session 9:

1. **Write your complete routine.** 5–7 sentences from morning to evening. Mix reflexive verbs and -ar/-er verbs. Add clock times.
2. **Say it without notes** on your third try.
3. **Describe someone else.** 2–3 sentences using *él/ella se...* and *él/ella + verb*.

Vocabulary to Know Before Week 5

See the full list in your Week 4 Vocabulary Reference. The most important items for Session 9 are:

- Core -er verbs (*comer, beber, leer*) and -ir verbs (*vivir, escribir*) in *yo, tú, él/ella* forms
- Reflexive verbs *levantarse, ducharse, prepararse, acostarse* in first person without notes
- The reflexive pronoun for *él/ella* (*se*) — contrasted with *yo* (*me*)
- Basic clock time: *son las + hour, es la una, a las + hour*